

in their roles as girlfriends and wives, say. Will a "Femlingual" arrive any time soon? We could just put it to the mouth of the subject. The device would say No when the Woman said Yes, and all the rest... you know. All those forwards are bloody true, if you ask us.

Actually, if you ask us, forget about *both* cats and women. Get yourself a faithful dog. At least you know what they mean.

Pfizer GENUINE ADVANTAGE

Spambots

Quacks peddling anti-erectile-dysfunction drugs are the most common spammers, and even if you do wish for some body parts to be larger than those of others, you just hit the Delete button. But what do you do when you get a mail about Viagra from Pfizer Inc.? (Pfizer makes Viagra, not Axis Herbs And Supplements, as the spammers would have you believe.) Well, you open the mail and scratch your head when you read about bargain Rolexes. You would

When Geeks Get Horney

Digit is the land of geeks, and our staff is not made up of just any breed of geek. We're arrogant, self-righteous and very, very narcissistic. As expected, there are arguments galore, on a daily basis.

Ed just uses his position to win his share of fights; Sanket does the same in the Test Centre. Michael usually uses his upper-body strength, which he spends two hours a day enhancing in our office gym. Robert (Raaabo) uses a mixture of his position, physical strength and rather large vocabulary of abuses to out-yell his opponents. The peaceful Ram has perfected the art of disappearing when there's conflict—very efficient this; you can't argue with someone you can't find.

Nimish, sadly, has everything going against

him. He's not senior enough; not old enough; not strong enough to throw his own considerable weight around... you get the picture. On a recent official trip to Singapore, he found his weapon of choice. Then during a meeting in a rather confined space, with everyone trying to out-shout the other, Nimish revealed his weapon to us:

"BHWAAAAAAAAAH"

Imagine that sound made at around 160 decibels; Nimish had bought himself a rather loud air-horn in Singapore. After we all put our skins back on, and the church bells in our heads stopped ringing, we quietly listened to his point of view, secretly vowing to kill him. He's laughing his head off for now, but we're patiently waiting for that little can of compressed air to run out—we'll see who has the last laugh.

DIGIT DIARY

possibly see details about penis enlargement products, and pitches for Valium, and also about Cialis, a Viagra competitor.

The MBA whizkid would, at this confounded point, trawl the business papers looking for Pfizer's latest business policies. Regular folks would wonder a little, then shrug their shoulders. But as a technology magazine that's keen on what's going on on the Net,

we want to know: has Pfizer gone to the bad? Etc.

Turns out Pfizer hasn't diversified, nor is it keen on uplifting competitors. Its computers have been infected by malware, and those now-misguided computers are spewing spam. Pfizer and its stakeholders are piqued.

Even after repeated warnings from security agencies, Pfizer continues to be oblivious to the

problem—they have a poor security record anyway. Somebody at the company once installed P2P software and inadvertently exposed the *personal* information of 17,000 employees. ("Jack uses Viagra! Paul's ditched Viagra for the pump!") Embarrassing then, embarrassing now—or has Pfizer really gone to the bad? As in, "Buy the *real* thing—don't go with what the spammers offer!"

Blog WATCH

The blogosphere certainly can't seem to stop talking about Apple's (mis?) adventures, but it's been quite an adventure for Apple: the iPhone (yes, we're sick of it too) was talked about much more than a pressing US national issue

Bluetooth support in iPod Touch?

-Nelson is one among many with iComplaints
<http://tinyurl.com/33em8c>

This is pretty cool... You shell out \$400 (Rs 17,170) for a brand new iPod Touch; you get it home and crack it open only to find out that Apple forgot to load the OS on the thing. I'm thinking that I would be pissed, and that's just what happened to a guy.

But something interesting popped up during the whole thing, the unit displays the icons that are activated and not activated. Cheerio for the serial number, very clever Apple. But the one that is the most interesting is the Bluetooth icon that is not active. This proves that they shipped the iPod with Bluetooth capability, and perhaps it can be activated with a firmware upgrade. I'm sure there's a hacker or two out there that's more than up to the task.

The people formerly known as informed

-Nick Carr: What's important, iPhone or iMmigration?
<http://tinyurl.com/2byhs3>

So what happens when "the people formally known as the audience," as the citizen journalism hysters like to say, take charge of the dissemination of news? (Researchers) examined the top stories appearing in the crowd-edited news sites Digg, Reddit, and Del.icio.us during a week in June and compared them to the top

stories covered by the mainstream media. They found that the stories in the user-driven sites were "more diverse" but also "more fragmented and transitory."

The immigration debate led the coverage in the mainstream media, accounting for 10% of all news stories. It appeared just once as a top-ten story on Reddit, and not at all on Digg and Del.icio.us.

What were the favorite stories on the user-driven sites? The only story with any real traction was the release of the Apple iPhone; it accounted for 16% of the stories on Digg that week.

Hey I got the new iPod Nano but...

-Douglas Kastle's Pos-synching woes
<http://tinyurl.com/37ou9l>

I hate iTunes, I've run it on I don't know how many machines and I find it clunky, buggy. I especially don't like the way it doesn't dynamically track a folder that has been added to a library... Winamp is a lot better and I've been using it for my iPod video for a while. When I plugged in the new Nano, Winamp recognised the Nano alright, and I copied over playlists, but when I ejected the Nano and tried to browse the music, nothing happened. Then I find the Net alive this morning with the Linux community finding the same problem, "iPods reengineered to block synching with Linux", I'm guessing this is the same problem I'm seeing in Winamp.